CHURN IS DEAD

The Product Friction Review

Help CS explain the customer problem clearly, let Product make the call, and give the customer an honest answer.

Use this before a Product Friction Review. Complete the five-part brief, run the 30-minute review, then record what the customer team can honestly communicate. This tool does not promise a delivery date.

Scoring: Score readiness from 1 to 5 in each section. A low score means the request is not ready for a Product decision.

Created by: Kuber Sethi
Source: churnisdead.com
Version: 1.0 -- November 2026

SECTION 1

Customer Consequence

> Product cannot assess a complaint that has no defined user, workflow, or consequence.

Field	Record This	Reject This
User	Role affected and relevant context	The customer
Workflow	Action the user is trying to complete	Needs feature X
Consequence	What happens when the action fails	They are unhappy
Frequency	How often and for whom it occurs	It happens a lot

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Clear user, workflow, consequence, and frequency	5
Some context but material ambiguity remains	3
Request is only a solution statement	1

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 2

Evidence and Workaround

Separate observed behaviour from account-team inference, then show the cost and limits of the current workaround.

Field	Evidence Required	Owner
Reproduction	Steps, product area, expected and actual behaviour	CS or Support
Artifacts	Screenshots, logs, quotes, or ticket references	CS or Support
Workaround	Current method, operator, frequency, and limits	CS
Unknowns	Facts still requiring investigation	Named owner

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Reproducible evidence and workaround limits are clear	5
Evidence exists but important unknowns remain	3
Only urgency or hearsay is provided	1

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 3

Commercial Timing and Privacy

Explain the next customer decision without spreading sensitive account data into broad product channels.

Field	Record Privately	Boundary
Decision	Renewal, rollout, review, expansion, or checkpoint	Do not call all friction renewal risk
Date	When the customer will make that decision	Use a real date, not soon
Context	Why this friction affects that decision	Do not paste contract value publicly
Promise	What has already been communicated	A request is not a commitment

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Decision, date, context, and prior promises are clear	5
Timing is known but the causal link is weak	3
Revenue pressure is asserted without context	1

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 4

Decision and Follow-through

> Every accepted packet needs an explicit state, owner, answer date, and customer communication plan.

Decision State	Required Record	Customer Message
Committed	Next step, owner, and date	State scope and what is not promised
Investigating	Specific unknown, owner, and answer date	Share when the next answer arrives
Declined	Reason and relevant alternative	Give a direct answer without backlog theatre
Evidence needed	Missing evidence and packet owner	Do not imply Product has accepted it

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
State, owner, date, and communication are recorded	5
Decision exists but follow-through is incomplete	3
Request returns to the backlog without a decision	1

Your Score: ____ / 5

CHURN IS DEAD

Your Scorecard

Dimension	Your Score	Max
1. Customer Consequence	____	5
2. Evidence and Workaround	____	5
3. Commercial Timing and Privacy	____	5
4. Decision and Follow-through	____	5
TOTAL	____	20

Total Score	Assessment	What It Means
16-20	Ready for review	The customer problem is clear enough for Product to answer.
12-15	Almost ready	Close the lowest-scoring evidence gap before review.
8-11	Evidence gaps	Important context is missing. Return it to the person who prepared the brief.
4-7	Not ready	This is still a request or escalation, not a clear customer problem.

What to do next: Complete the weakest part of the brief before asking Product for an answer. Then book one review and record the answer, owner, and date.

The goal is not to win every roadmap argument. The goal is to end backlog ambiguity.

Kuber
churnisdead.com | Weekly frameworks that replace hope with strategy.